

Committee on Budget, Finance and Administration

REPORT ON DIVERSITY IN THE WTO SECRETARIAT

Response to Measures Proposed in Joint Statement by Brazil, China,
Ecuador, Egypt, India, Pakistan and South Africa

I. INTRODUCTION

1. At the meeting of the Committee on Budget, Finance and Administration (CBFA) on 11 March 2010, the Secretariat presented its first Annual Report on Diversity in the Secretariat (WT/BFA/W/195). A Joint Statement on the Report on Diversity by Brazil, China, Ecuador, Egypt, India, Pakistan and South Africa, was also tabled. The purpose of this document is to provide a response to the measures proposed in the joint statement.

2. The discussion in the Committee on Budget, Finance and Administration following the presentation of the first annual report on diversity was of great value to the WTO Secretariat. Several practical and useful suggestions were made, for example, in relation to increasing outreach to attract the best qualified candidates from Members as a way to further continue to broaden the diversification of the Secretariat staff.

3. The Secretariat and the Director-General place great importance on diversity and will work to ensure that the positive trends highlighted in the Secretariat's Annual Report on Diversity are not only continued but reinforced over time. Increasing the pool of highly qualified applicants from the full Membership is key to achieving this and developing a stronger partnership with Members will greatly enhance the potential for success in this area.

II. PROPOSED MEASURES AND SECRETARIAT ACTIONS

4. The table below sets out the proposed measures presented in the Joint Statement on the Report on Diversity by Brazil, China, Ecuador, Egypt, India, Pakistan and South Africa and planned actions by the Secretariat.

Table 1

Secretariat Response & Actions to Proposed Measures presented
in the Joint Statement on the Report on Diversity
by Brazil, China, Ecuador, Egypt, India, Pakistan and South Africa.

Measures proposed in Joint Statement to the CBFA	Secretariat Response and Actions
1. A Strengthened Diversification Policy. This could be achieved by revising the <i>Staff Regulation</i> with more elaborated language on diversification or by formulating a separate statement or policy paper on diversification to be approved by the General Council. The language could be closely aligned along UN Organizations, World Bank, IMF, ITC, etc.	♦ The WTO Staff Regulations (Staff Regulation 3.1) set out the principles of merit and equal opportunity for all, as well as the objective of ensuring the broadest possible diversification of the Secretariat. As stated in the Secretariat's report on diversity, staff recruitment is firmly based on these principles, with merit being the principal selection criterion. When candidates are equal on merit, diversity needs are taken into account and reflected in the final selection decision. The UN, World Bank, IMF and ITC statements on diversity are aligned to these same principles. ♦ To reinforce and increase communications and awareness of the Staff Regulations and principles of merit and diversity, the Secretariat will take forward the following actions in 2010/2011: - Implement Diversity Training within the Secretariat, with a focus on further raising managers' and selection panels' awareness of the importance of merit and diversity in recruitment. - Increase communication, internally and externally, on the WTO recruitment process and diversity as set out in the WTO Staff Regulations (e.g. diversity recruitment brochure, diversity statement on WTO website, employment at the WTO booklet to make available at WTO events).
2. An Enhanced Recruitment with Diversification. This could be achieved by inserting in future recruitment notices a clear-cut language to give preference to candidates	♦ As set out above, it is the view of the Secretariat that the current recruitment policy, as set out in Staff Regulation 3.1, remains appropriate. Maintaining merit as the prime consideration in recruitment

Measures proposed in Joint Statement to the CBFA	Secretariat Response and Actions
from under/non-represented members subject to their meeting eligibility criteria.	ensures that the best talent is selected and the highest quality of services is provided to Members by the Secretariat. ♦ The Secretariat is of the view that measures such as increasing awareness of diversity and strengthening outreach and communication will be effective in increasing the pool of diverse, qualified applications from all Members, especially under-represented Members. These actions will ensure that the positive trends highlighted in the report on diversity are not only continued but reinforced, while retaining/improving organizational effectiveness and excellence. - A short text on the Secretariat's commitment to merit and diversity in line with the WTO Staff Regulations will be reinforced in future vacancy notices.
3. An Improved Outreach to Potential Candidates. This could be achieved by adding new dimension to existing activities of the WTO, particularly the TRTA activities such as Trade Policy Courses, Regional and National Workshops, Public Forum and Geneva Week to further improve the dissemination of relevant information and reach out to potential candidates, particularly those from under/non-represented Members.	♦ As proposed by several Members, the Human Resources Division will increase outreach by providing greater information and communication on WTO recruitment criteria and procedures during Trade Related Technical Assistance (TRTA) activities such as: the Trade Policy Courses, Workshops, Public Forum and Geneva Week. For example, the Human Resources Division gave presentations on Recruitment and Diversity and how Members can assist in helping the Secretariat to attract and increase the pool of qualified applicants, at the following activities: - at Geneva Week on 7 May 2010; - it is also planning future presentations later in the year at Public Forum, Trade Policy Courses and other workshops.

Measures proposed in Joint Statement to the CBFA	Secretariat Response and Actions
	♦ The Human Resources Division also stands ready to assist Delegations with any questions or needs they may have related to recruitment. It is clearly in the interest of the Secretariat to ensure maximum outreach so as to increase the pool of highly qualified applicants from the full Membership.
4. A Regular Review of the Situation and Discussion on Way Forward. This could be achieved with a regular review based on the annual report by the Secretariat on diversity as contained in DG's 2010-2011 biennium budget proposals and subsequent discussion among Members on the way forward. CBFA should report such reviews and discussions and possible measures to be taken to the General Council.	♦ The Secretariat will provide Members with regular updates through annual reports to the CBFA on Diversity: - 2009 Annual Report on Diversity in WTO was presented to CBFA in March 2010. - 2010 Annual Report on Diversity in WTO will be presented to CBFA at its first meeting in 2011. ♦ The Secretariat stands ready to support further discussion among Members on the subject of diversity, including by providing additional updates.

III. CONCLUSION

5. The Human Resources Division will continue to carry out planned actions as outlined above, and will report to the CBFA on progress in this area.

6. The Secretariat will present its second Annual Report on Diversity in the WTO Secretariat during 2010 at the first meeting of the CBFA in 2011.
